

an exhaustive list, in this chapter we give you a brief overview of some of the most popular Google Apps. For a full list you can go here: <http://dgit.in/plyaps>

Play Store

Arguably, the most important Google App of all. The Google Play Store is pretty much a one stop shop where you can choose between all sorts of digital media, from TV shows to one of the 2.8 million apps that are available. It's a platform where you can search, buy and download books, movies, music and apps which are instantly synced between all your devices that are signed into the Play Store. The Play Store came into being on March 6th, 2012 – replacing three other products before it: The Android Market, Google Music and Google eBookstore. The launch of the Play Store as a standalone application can probably be heralded as the beginning of the formation and unification of a cohesive Google ecosystem as it brought together most of the budding elements together into one package. The UI is as simple as it gets – you get a massive search bar when you open up the app with recommendation and a chart list below. Search for an app by name or tag, or click on the fancy art on the recommendation list and voila, you are at the app download page where you can proceed to buy/download it. Repeat for music or other media and you've got yourself a winning combination on your hands – simple enough to make getting new stuff less tedious but at the same time, exciting enough to get the “buying new stuff” thrill. And that's all there is to it.

Play Music

Let's face it – unless you are a serious audiophile who needs his foobar2k or for some strange reason you really hate the UI, Google Play Music is likely to be the default music player on everyone's phone (unless of course there is a skin on Android with another default app pushed by your phone manufacturer). First introduced as Google Music way back in 2011, it went through a major revamp in the next couple of years. With Google being displeased with the adoption rates and revenues, it soon allowed songs to be download in 320 kbps (upto 2 times per song from the web). It also got renamed to Google Play Music when the whole restructuring of the Play Store occurred. Apart from being a fairly simple yet competent local device music player, Play Music also lets you upload upto 50,000 tracks to the cloud – for free. You can sync your libraries and access them on upto 10 devices, making maintenance super easy. Play Music also has a paid streaming service called